

Good afternoon Conference Members,

We are providing you the background documentation that the General Service Board reviewed which supported the need for this difficult and important decision regarding the 71st General Service Conference.

The trustees' General Service Conference committee continued discussions at its October 31, 2020 meeting and put forward a recommendation to the General Service Board. On Monday, November 2, 2020 the Board reviewed and discussed the recommendation and approved, with 100% unanimity, the following motion regarding the 71st General Service Conference:

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation that the 71st General Service Conference be conducted during the scheduled time period of April 18-24, 2021 via remote meeting technology. Sessions of the 71st Conference will be conducted on a digital platform.

The Board members wanted to thank the Delegate Chair and Conference Committee Chairs for their participation in the October 15, 2020 Special meeting of the trustees' General Service Conference Committee. Your voices, as well as all Conference members, were heard at the special meeting, in the Conference evaluations and recent surveys. Your feedback continues to be valued, needed and important as we move forward with planning.

Please find attached the following:

- Epidemiological reporting on safety concerns
- Report on industry best practices
- Current CDC Guiding Principles on Gatherings
- Current travel guidelines

The total estimated cost reviewed for a Virtual 71st General Service Conference is \$285,100.

The total estimated cost reviewed for an in-person socially distanced 71st General Service Conference is \$1,847,050.

If you any questions, your Regional Trustees are at the ready to share with you.

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